

Decent Coaching Classes

IX CBSE

Academic Conquest - I

Subject: English

Chapters: Winds of Change, Canvas of Soil, Vitamin-M, I Cannot Remember My Mother

Maximum Marks: 30

Time: 1 hour

General Instructions:

- (i) This paper is divided into four Sections — A, B, C and D.
- (ii) All questions are compulsory unless stated otherwise.
- (iii) Write answers in complete sentences wherever required.

Section A — Prose (12 Marks)

Q1. Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow: [4]

"Over time, pankhas became significant cultural goods distributed through trade routes. They were considered exotic and stylish. Although there was substantial commonality in their use across India, different villages and towns developed their own varieties of traditional pankhas."

- (a) Name the region-specific varieties of pankhas mentioned in the chapter, from any two states.
- (b) Why does the writer describe the pankhas as 'traditional'?
- (c) State whether the following is True or False: Pankhas were one of the most popular items of commerce. (Give a reason.)
- (d) Choose the correct option: The word 'indigenous' (as used for pankhas) means —
 - (i) imported
 - (ii) local, originating from a place
 - (iii) expensive
 - (iv) old-fashioned

Q2. Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow: [4]

"Off he went, twirling his walking stick jauntily, leaving Ravi in a dilemma. His grandfather would feel hurt if he insisted on accompanying him and his mother would be furious if she knew Ravi had let him go out on his own."

- (a) What was the 'dilemma' that Ravi found himself in?
- (b) What does the word 'jauntily' tell us about Grandpa's mood at this point?
- (c) What decision did Ravi finally take?
- (d) Pick out one word from the extract that means 'a situation requiring a choice between equally undesirable options'.

Q3. Answer any two of the following questions in 30–40 words each: [4]

- (a) Why did Ravi's mother insist that Grandpa should not go out alone?
- (b) How does the chapter 'Winds of Change' show that the pankha is more than just an object of daily use?
- (c) What surprise did Grandpa have in store for the family, and why did it embarrass Ravi's mother?

Section B — Poetry (10 Marks)

Q4. Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow: [4]

*"Palette of earth, rich and deep,
Where dreams of gardeners seep.
Brushstrokes of seeds, planted true,*

Awaiting spring's vibrant hue."

- (a) Identify the metaphor used in the second line and explain what is being compared.
- (b) What does the poet mean by 'Brushstrokes of seeds'?
- (c) Which word in the extract means 'shade of a colour'?
- (d) What is the rhyme scheme of this stanza?

Q5. Read the extract given below and answer the questions that follow: [4]

*"I cannot remember my mother
but when in the early autumn morning
the smell of the shiuli flowers floats in the air
the scent of the morning service in the temple
comes to me as the scent of my mother."*

- (a) Which sense (sight, smell, sound) is central to this stanza?
- (b) Why can the poet not remember his mother directly?
- (c) What is the poetic device used in the repetition of the opening line across the poem called?
- (d) In your own words, explain what triggers the poet's memory of his mother in this stanza.

Q6. Answer the following question in 30–40 words: [2]

Both 'Canvas of Soil' and 'I Cannot Remember My Mother' use imagery drawn from nature. Compare, briefly, how each poem uses nature to convey its central idea.

Section C — Vocabulary and Grammar (4 Marks)

Q7. Match the words in Column A with their meanings in Column B (any four): [2]

Column A	Column B
1. frail	(a) actions to improve a situation
2. initiatives	(b) weak, fragile
3. solemnly	(c) linger or remain near a place
4. hover	(d) seriously
5. jauntily	(e) happily and confidently

Q8. Do as directed (any four): [2]

- (a) Fill in the blank with a suitable preposition: The vendors sitting _____ the banyan tree gave Ravi quizzical looks.
- (b) Change into indirect speech: Ravi asked, "Shall we play chess or watch the cricket match, Grandpa?"
- (c) Fill in the blank with the present perfect form of the verb: Puppetry _____ (evolve) over the years, blending tradition with technology.
- (d) Identify the part of speech of the underlined word: Grandpa walked briskly towards the bus stop.
- (e) Give one synonym and one antonym for the word 'humiliation'.

Section D — Writing (4 Marks)

Q9. Attempt any one of the following in about 80–100 words: [4]

- (a) Write a short article for your school magazine titled 'Our Inspiring Elderly', drawing on the lessons Ravi learns from Grandpa in 'Vitamin-M'.
- (b) Write a diary entry describing a craft item (like a pankha) that you or someone in your family has made or used, focusing on its appearance and material.

ANSWER KEY

Section A — Prose

Q1.

- (a) Rajasthan — appliqué, zardozi, and temple hand fans; Gujarat — mirror-work, beads, and embroidered leather hand fans; West Bengal — sola (Tal Patar) hand fans; Uttar Pradesh — Phadhs hand fans; Bihar — bamboo hand fans (any two states).
- (b) Because different villages and towns developed their own distinct, long-established varieties of pankhas passed down over generations, using materials and designs unique to their region.
- (c) False — Pankhas were considered exotic and stylish cultural goods, but the text does not state they were among the most popular items of commerce overall.
- (d) (ii) local, originating from a place

Q2.

- (a) Ravi did not know whether to insist on accompanying Grandpa (which would hurt his feelings) or let him go alone (which would upset his mother, who had told Ravi not to let Grandpa go out unsupervised).
- (b) It shows that Grandpa was cheerful, confident, and pleased to be going out on his own, without a trace of the frailty his daughter feared.
- (c) Ravi decided to secretly follow Grandpa at a safe distance to make sure he came to no harm, without letting Grandpa know.
- (d) Dilemma

Q3. (Any two)

- (a) Grandpa had slipped and fallen in his garden one evening and lain outside all night because no one was home to help him; this, along with an earlier incident of getting lost, made Ravi's mother worried about his safety and unwilling to let him live alone or go out unaccompanied.
- (b) The chapter shows that pankhas carry the cultural identity, history, and craftsmanship of the regions that make them, reflecting materials, traditions, and even legends of a place — making them cultural artefacts, not merely functional tools.
- (c) Grandpa announced that he always gives every child in the house a birthday gift on his own birthday; this reminded Ravi's mother that she had forgotten to prepare a gift for her father, and she flushed with embarrassment, especially when Grandpa jokingly said she needed 'Vitamin-M' for her own memory.

Section B — Poetry

Q4.

- (a) The earth/soil is metaphorically compared to a painter's palette, suggesting that the soil holds all the potential colours (life) a garden will eventually display.
- (b) The seeds, once sown, are compared to brushstrokes that will eventually create the picture (garden) — the beginning marks of a larger artwork.
- (c) Hue
- (d) AABB (rhyming couplets)

Q5.

- (a) Smell (olfactory sense).
- (b) Because his mother passed away when he was too young to form a lasting memory of her, so it is only sensory triggers — like scent — that bring back a feeling of her presence.
- (c) Refrain
- (d) The fragrance of the shiuli flowers in the early autumn morning air, similar to the scent of morning worship in the temple, reminds the poet of his mother's presence.

Q6.

In 'Canvas of Soil', nature (the garden) is used as an extended metaphor for art itself, showing how growth and blooming resemble the process of painting. In 'I Cannot Remember My Mother', natural sensory details — a tune, the scent of shiuli flowers, the blue sky — are used to evoke fragments of a lost memory, connecting nature to personal loss and longing rather than to creativity.

Section C — Vocabulary and Grammar

Q7. 1-(b), 2-(a), 3-(d), 4-(c), 5-(e)

Q8.

- (a) under
- (b) Ravi asked Grandpa if/whether they should play chess or watch the cricket match. (Accept: Ravi asked Grandpa whether they should play chess or watch the cricket match on TV.)
- (c) has evolved
- (d) Adverb (of manner)
- (e) Synonym: embarrassment/humiliation-related word such as 'disgrace' or 'mortification';
Antonym: 'honour' or 'dignity'.

Section D — Writing

Marking note: Award marks for content relevance, organisation into paragraphs, and language accuracy. Accept any well-structured response that fulfils the format and word limit.